

know.”

It wasn't so much the words but the angry guilt-trip that went with the words that got to me.

Or the reverse guilt-trip was the “I'm sacrificing my life to buy this for you. I'm buying this for you because I never had this advantage when I was a kid.” I have a neighbor who is stone broke, but can't park his car in his garage. The garage is filled with toys for his kids. Those spoiled brats get everything they ask for. “I don't want them to know the feeling of want” are his everyday words. He has nothing set aside for their college or his retirement, but his kids have every toy ever made. He recently got a new credit card in the mail and took his kids to visit Las Vegas. “I'm doing it for the kids,” he said with great sacrifice.

Rich dad forbade the words “I can't afford it.”

In my real home, that's all I heard. Instead, rich dad required his children to say, “How can I afford it?” His reasoning, the words “I can't afford it” shut down your brain. It didn't have to think anymore. “How can I afford it?” opened up the brain. Forced it to think and search for answers.

But most importantly, he felt the words “I can't afford it” were a lie. And the human spirit knew it. “The human spirit is very, very, powerful,” he would say. “It knows it can do anything.” By having a lazy mind that says, “I can't afford it,” a war breaks out inside you. Your spirit is angry, and your lazy mind must defend its lie. The spirit is screaming, “Come on. Let's go to the gym and work out.” And the lazy mind says, “But I'm tired. I worked really hard today.” Or the human spirit says, “I'm sick and tired of being poor. Let's get out there and get rich.” To which the lazy mind says, “Rich people are greedy. Besides it's too much bother.

It's not safe. I might lose money. I'm working hard enough as it is. I've got too much to do at work anyway. Look at what I have to do tonight. My boss wants it finished by the morning.”

“I can't afford it” also brings up sadness. A helplessness that leads to ' despondency and often depression. “Apathy” is another word. “How can I afford it?” opens up possibilities, excitement and dreams. So rich dad , was not so concerned about what you wanted to buy, but that “How can 'f j I afford it?” created a stronger mind and a dynamic spirit.

Thus, he rarely gave Mike or me anything. Instead he would ask, “How can you afford it?” and that included college, which we paid for ourselves. It was not the goal but the process of attaining the goal we desired that he wanted us to learn. The problem I sense today is that there are millions of people who feel guilty about their greed. It's an old conditioning from their childhood. Their desire to have the finer things